Other languages might use the term *interning* to refer to the process of having a single internal representation for all objects with the same value. They call symbols *interned strings* or *atoms*.

Regular Expressions

Regular expression literals are objects of type Regexp. They are created explicitly by calling new or implicitly by using the literal forms, /_pattern_/ and %r{_pattern_}. The %r construct is a form of general delimited input (described on page 444).

```
/pattern/

/pattern/options

%r{pattern}

%r{pattern}options

Regexp.new("pattern" ‹, options›)
```

options is one or more of i (case insensitive), o (substitute once), m (. matches newline), and x (allow spaces and comments). You can additionally override the default encoding of the pattern with n (no encoding-ASCII), e (EUC), s (Shift_JIS), or u (UTF-8).

Within a regular expression, each entry in this list matches the characters described in its description. Most characters match themselves, but several special characters or patterns have defined matches. An asterisk at the end of an entry in the following list means that the match is extended beyond ASCII characters if Unicode option is set.

characters	All except . | ( ) [\ ^ { + $ * and ? match themselves. To match one of these characters, precede it with a backslash.
\a \c*x* \e \f \r \t \u*nnnn* \v \x*nn* *nnn* \C-\M-*x* \C-*x* \M-x	Match the character derived according to Table 9, Substitutions in double-quoted strings, on page 435.
^	Match the beginning of a line.
$	Match the end of a line.
\A	Match the beginning of the entire string.
\z, \Z	Match the end of the entire string. \Z ignores trailing \n.
\d, \h	Match any decimal digit or hexadecimal digit ([0-9a-fA-F]).*
\s	Matches any whitespace character: tab, newline, vertical tab, formfeed, return, and space.*
\w	Matches any word character: alphanumerics and underscores.*
\D, \H, \S, \W	The negated forms of \d, \h, \s, and \w, matching characters that are not digits, hexadecimal digits, whitespace, or word characters.*
\b, \B	Match word/nonword boundaries.
\G	The position where a previous repetitive search completed.
\K	Discards the portion of the match to the left of the \K.
\R	A generic end-of-line sequence.*
\X	A Unicode grapheme.*